to Chandigarh, so we would have to cover less distance the next day. On the morning of 1 December, we started by road while my predecessor, Lt Gen Robin Soni, left by air to take over as Army Commander Southern Command. Immediately on arrival, I reviewed the Guard of Honour at Annadale, possibly the only flat piece of ground in Shimla, which also doubles up as the helipad. Then to a War Memorial of sorts right on the main road, just outside the main gate, to pay homage to our brave soldiers and finally, to the office where I was introduced to the officers.

HQ ARTRAC has a very different role and organizational structure as compared with the other regional commands. To start with, it does not have any operational role whatsoever. It has no troops under its command. In fact, the HQ ARTRAC falls within the administrative jurisdiction of Western Command for many purposes. Based on its training role, the organogram of the HQ was quite different, without the traditional branches one was accustomed to. At ARTRAC, the main branches were the Training Branch, the Doctrine Branch and the Red Forces (REDFOR) Branch, each headed by a Maj Gen. When I initially assumed charge, it took me some time to figure out which branch handled what. Sometimes I would even ask my SPS, a civilian by the name of Ajay, who had been there for many years, for advice. He had seen many Army Commanders come and go and was a rich source of information on what were the pitfalls to avoid. Soon after taking over, I called on the Governor, Acharya Devvrat, and the Chief Minister, Shri Jai Ram Thakur.[1]

As the Army Commander, I was now authorized a Military Adviser for whom I chose Brig Satish Dahiya of 14 SIKH LI. For the Col MS and ADC, I recalled Col Katoch and Capt Amit Uppal. Col Katoch joined me in Shimla, leaving

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